

Sean Gatewood

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Summary

Senior DevOps / Platform Engineer with a focus on the **dev** side of DevOps. I build scalable, reproducible, and reliable production environments with Kubernetes ecosystems, Infrastructure as Code, and CI/CD pipelines. I bring strong development skills to the infra world, elevating production environments with seamless automation, custom microservices, proactive application-level fixes, and spikes that push the boundaries of what is possible.

Experience

Senior Software Engineer, Castellum.AI (New York, NY / remote)

October 2025 - Present

- Developing / hardening the full infrastructure story for a startup, while also contributing to core product features.
- Modernizing deployment infrastructure, monitoring, developer tooling/environments, and CI/CD workflows.
- Reduced average CI pipeline time by ~60%, significantly improving developer iteration speed.
- Migrated core Vertex (Google) AI integration from Go to a Python microservice and deployed it in Kubernetes.
- Deployed the LiteLLM proxy in K8s to make our AI integrations provider-agnostic, reducing vendor lock-in as AI models and pricing changes rapidly.
- Utilized LiteLLM architecture to formally benchmark leading AI models standalone vs within our product, showing how our harness lifts accuracy across models to support Marketing's buy-vs-build case.
- Set up a CDC service to sync Postgres to Elasticsearch in a continuous and durable fashion.
- Provisioned Prometheus/Grafana stack in our clusters to quickly close critical gaps in observability.
- Created dashboards and alerts on structured logs in Elastic Cloud.
- Started our use of terraform to manage infrastructure using code instead of manual browser clicks.
- Productionalized local dev utilizing direnv / nix / Justfile so each repo works out of the box for a new hire with a single command.
- Helped maintain SOC 2 compliance by orchestrating and completing a Disaster Recovery and addressing security/infrastructure audit findings.
- Utilized AI coding tools (Claude Code and Cursor) to rapidly implement solutions and triage incidents.

DevOps Engineer, Digital Asset (New York, NY / remote)

April 2023 - October 2025

- Developed infrastructure and automation around critical kubernetes services, applying SRE practices to ensure reliability and minimize operational toil.
- Played an instrumental role in the launch of our blockchain network by owning the greenfield deployment & management of a core SuperValidator node.
- Utilized Terraform, Jsonnet, Bash, and Helm to automate deployments in a flexible manner, enabling the success of more than 70 weekly SV upgrades.
- Orchestrated a complex blockchain migration process in the deployment automation, reducing required live-on-zoom code changes down to 0.
- Migrated our node's cluster across GCP regions with less than 2 minutes of downtime.
- Instrumented monitoring/alerts with DataDog to maintain 99.5% uptime and tune our configuration to minimize cloud costs.
- Communicated deployment designs with partner companies, helping them overcome similar hurdles and accelerating the launch of our blockchain network.
- Mentored 2 teammates on how the validator deployment worked so they could contribute to the codebase and participate in support rotations.
- Authored a Prometheus metrics exporter in Go, providing a programmatic framework for custom metrics. Closed 8 critical gaps in production observability.
- Authored a Kubernetes operator in Go to streamline our backup/restore process, eliminating operational tasks on a product entering maintenance mode.
- Migrated Kubernetes manifests from a legacy system to public helm charts, allowing external customers to deploy our product.
- Orchestrated our internal helm installations using Helmfile to reduce our deployment process from 35 commands to 1 and pave the way for using GitOps.
- Built isolated blockchain test environments in both k3d (for local dev) and vClusters, allowing developers to effortlessly spin up fully independent networks.
- Developed CI/CD pipelines using Google Cloud Build and CircleCI.
- Participated in on-call rotations, triaging a multitude of production alerts and maintaining the reliability of our services.

Software Engineer II, Appian Corporation (McLean, VA / remote)

August 2020 - April 2023

- Worked on a Development Experience team that owned a variety of tooling and infrastructure to accelerate and modernize development workflows.
- Contributed to a remote development platform allowing devs to build/develop/test on dedicated EC2s, improving cycle time and stability by at least 50%.
- Built a Gitlab pipeline to precook warm builds that devs could take and use instantly, reducing setup time from ~12m to ~5s for many common test cases.
- Architected a separate mode using [Mutagen](#) to enable bi-directional file syncing and enhance stability.
- Deployed a LaunchDarkly [relay proxy](#) in Kubernetes, satisfying a FedRAMP security requirement for our modern feature toggles initiative.
- Contributed to a team effort to integrate LaunchDarkly with a legacy product, including developing our own Java client.
- Regularly initiated & led architectural design discussions, and spiked a wide variety of prototypes.
- Regularly unblocked developers by assisting in troubleshooting technical issues, improving our local build stability.
- Utilized an ELK stack to collect diagnostics from our development tool, greatly enhancing visibility into command utilization and user flows.
- Enhanced our documentation by injecting Matplotlib graphs (refreshed daily via Gitlab deployment pipeline) to show metrics on our codebase over time.
- Treasured high code quality standards and contributed to our data-driven goal to lead the department in code quality.
- Mentored two interns as a Summer Intern Manager, meeting with them weekly to optimize their internship experience.
- Gained a high standard for usability that continues to shape my tooling designs today.

Teaching Assistant - Introduction to Programming, University of Virginia (Charlottesville, VA)

Fall 2017 - May 2020

- Assisted hundreds of students with introductory programming concepts in Python.
- Created [review videos](#) that have received over 13,000 views.
- Helped manage the course as one of four "Head TAs."

Selected Skills

Languages Python, Bash, Go, Java, TypeScript, C++	Kubernetes Helm, Helmfile, FluxCD, Istio, Custom Operators	Monitoring Grafana, Prometheus, Datadog
Cloud Platforms GCP, AWS, Digital Ocean	Infrastructure As Code Terraform, Pulumi	CI / CD GitLab, Github Actions, CircleCI, GCB, Jenkins

Cloud Resources ("I've terraformed it!")

Compute (GKE Cluster, Node Pools, Persistent Disks, Snapshot Schedules, VMs), Networking (VPC, Subnet, Cloud NAT, L7 Application Load Balancer, MCI, Cloud DNS, Google-Managed Certificates), Security (IAM, RBAC, Secrets Manager, Cloud Armor, Service Accounts, Workload Identity)

Other

Docker, Docker Compose, SQL, LaunchDarkly, MermaidJS, Nix, Jsonnet, Auth0, Kotlin, Gradle, Linux, jq, Justfile, Git, GitHub

Side Projects

- [This Resume](#): Written in YAML and templated into the document you are reading. :-)
- [JobDeployment controller](#): Spiked an idea I had using [kubebuilder](#) to solve a DX problem with deploying Job objects in helm charts.
- [gcloud-fzf](#): Wrote a Go CLI I wanted. The interesting part is I actually distributed it via homebrew.
- [Portfolio site](#): Used an old Jekyll theme I liked to serve as my website. Includes some interesting dark mode & MermaidJS hacks.

Education

University of Virginia (May 2020) Rodman Scholar, Raven Society

- B.S. Computer Science. GPA 3.95

Notable Courses: Computer Graphics, Algorithms, Introduction to Cybersecurity, Software Testing